

WEB SCRIPTING USING HYPERTEXT MARKUP LANGUAGE (HTML)

Hypertext Markup Language consists of *tags* that are interpreted by the web browser to display text when the HTML file is opened on the screen by Web browser software.

A **Tag** is a special word enclosed between the less than and greater than (< >) symbols, and the browser can interpret it as a command.

E.g., to start a HTML page, type; <HTML> at the top of the document.

The **Markup tags** tell the internet Browser that the file contains HTML-coded information. They also define the various components of a WWW document such as tables, paragraphs, and lists.

Web pages are written using HTML in a text format that provides many features such as the capability for in-line graphics, font control, and Hypertext links. A **Hypertext link** is a word or phrase in an HTML-document that enables the user to jump to another Web page, or connect to another Web Server.

HTML is simple, doesn't have the declaration part and control structures. In addition, it has many limitations; hence, cannot be used alone when developing functional websites.

To add functionality to the HTML pages, some special blocks of code known as **scripts** are inserted in HTML pages using scripting languages like *JavaScript*, *VBScript* and *Hypertext Preprocessor*.

A **Script** is a small program fragment, written in a different language other than HTML, but inserted into the HTML program.

Most HTML tags have an opening tag and a closing tag. An opening tag is enclosed between < >, while a closing tag is enclosed between </ >. The text that is to be displayed on the screen is enclosed between an opening and closing tag.

HTML Tag	Meaning
<HTML> </HTML>	Marks the beginning and end of a HTML document. All other tags and text fall between these two tags.
<HEAD></HEAD>	Marks the header part of the document
<TITLE></TITLE>	Gives the title of the web page. The text between these tags will appear in the title bar when the HTML document page is running or browsed.
<BODY></BODY>	Marks the body part of the document
<CENTER></CENTER>	Centers text and objects on the web page
	Bolds the text on the web page, e.g., the statement Hello will display the word "Hello" in bold on the screen
<I></I>	Italicize the text
<H1></H1>	Sets the size of the text on the web page with H6 displaying the smallest and H1 the largest size

Creating a script using JavaScript

Before writing your HTML program with a script inserted, make sure you have the latest browser software installed on your computer.

e.g., if you're using Internet Explorer, it should be version 5.0 and above.

1. Open Notepad, and type the following program.
2. Save your file on the desktop as *Example.html*, and then close the notepad. Notice that the icon to your file on the desktop looks like that of the default web browser in your computer.
3. To view the web page, double-click the icon of the file *Example.html* on the desktop.

	Explanation
<HTML>	The tag <HTML> marks the beginning of the HTML document
<HEAD> <TITLE> Baraton Teachers College</TITLE> </HEAD>	Displays the text Baraton Teachers College in the title bar of the running HTML document. The title is written in the header section, i.e., between<HEAD> and </HEAD> tags.
<BODY>	It marks the beginning of the body section. Anything between<BODY> and </BODY> will be executed and displayed when the web page starts running.
<H1> <CENTER> We are the world </CENTER> </H1>	This line will display the text We are the world on the screen. The text will be large, i.e., size H1 and it will be centered on the screen. The text will also be bolded.
<SCRIPT LANGUAGE = 'JavaScript'>	Marks the start point of the script. The line LANGUAGE = 'JavaScript' tells the browser that the script will be written in JavaScript language.
Document.Write ('My name is strongman');	The statement Document. Write tells the browser to write whatever is in the brackets using JavaScript. NB. In JavaScript, the end of a statement is marked by a semicolon (;).
Alert ('congratulations for succeeding to run this script');	The word alert displays a message box on the screen with an OK button. Clicking the button makes the message box to disappear. The text in the brackets appears in the dialog box.
</SCRIPT>	Closes the script
</BODY> </HTML>	Marks the end of the body, and the HTML code.

Practical activity

1. Open a text editor program on your computer like Notepad or WordPad, and type the following program.

```
<HTML>
```

```
<HEAD>
```

```
<TITLE> Hello! This is my first webpage </TITLE>
```

```
</HEAD>
```

```
<BODY bgcolor = "Blue">
```

```
<H3><CENTER><B>Hello World</B></CENTER></H3>
```

```
</BODY>
```

```
</HTML>
```

2. Save your file on the desktop as *Webpage.html*, and make sure that the *Save As Type* box reads "All Files" before clicking the **Save** button.
3. Close your text editor.
4. Double-click the icon of the file on the desktop to view the web page.
5. Change your background to blue, and save your program..